[Priorities in Rules]

- Balancing between skilful gameplay and setup variety

Different rules' powerlevels have different levels of skilful gameplay and setup variety so that people have more fun. This is the main reason why we have many of the top setups banned, as the majority of them do not have as much skill expression (like thrusting shields) and the ruleset would become dominated by any single one of them that would be unbanned leaving little room for alternatives. This is also why some setups have damage restrictions rather than outright banning them, as this increases the pool of viable setups. This ruleset isn't the only way to do it and we could definitely move the power-level slider in either direction.

- Ruleset Bloat

Whilst we could balance every single aspect of the game to make it as perfectly balanced as possible, the ruleset would become extremely unwieldy even compared to the current ruleset. That is why there are occasionally rules, like the player buff ban, that have a few unnecessary bans tied to it in order to lump together all of the problematic things that need to be banned under one rule.

- Community consensus

Even if not everyone can be happy about a rules change/decision, we want to prioritise ensuring that the community feels heard and that they have a say in the ruleset that they're playing in. The community votes on rules and rarely is a change put in place that hasn't already gotten a substantial amount of votes.

- Anti-Stall

These rulesets have been designed for the sake of being used in Tournaments and Ladder. Especially for tournaments that are streamed, in the interest of time there's a large amount of stall tactics, or buffs that force the opponent to stall which we have banned in order to ensure that the tournaments finish efficiently. Additionally, stalling tactics are generally not fun for either player, so these tactics are also banned for the interest of keeping the game fun and interactive for everyone involved.

- Increasing TTK

TTK, meaning Time To Kill, is referenced a lot in rules discussions because one of our priorities is that we want to make sure that fights take a meaningful amount of interactions to showcase a difference in skill. We increase the TTK in order to increase the sample size of decision making and interactions so that on average the better player will come out on top more often with a fight.

- Competitive Integrity

Whilst not a hard requirement, something we want is for the ruleset to promote active competition between players, so *some* strategies that are cheesy, or one sided in terms of effort may be limited or banned in order to ensure that we keep a level of Competitive Integrity between players. Part of this is due to tournaments being some of the most public showings of how the ruleset functions, and so we want less opportunities for players to be pushed away from participating.

- Fairness

While not all setups are created equally, there's still a goal to ensure that players don't have a completely mismatched amount of effort needed to win. For example, with Stone Club. If both players play completely perfectly, Stone club should never be able to win. However, people aren't robots and

the room for mistakes when fighting against a setup like that is vastly smaller than the amount of mistakes the Stone Club player can get away with, which explains its restrictions.

[GENERAL]

- Player Buffs Globally Banned.

Any buff that stays for its duration regardless of equipped weapon. (Excludes effects from crystal tears/talismans/equipment/armour)

The counterplay for the majority of buffs in this game is to either mirror your opponent or stall it out which is something that we want to avoid as part of the ruleset's priorities. These buffs may include things such as Black Flame Protection, Radiant Baldachin's Blessing, Unseen Form, Rallying Standard, Starlight Shards, etc.

- All Passive tick-based HP Regen via Armour/Talismans/Shields/Ashes
- All Methods of Passive Regen/Flat Heals/% Heals applied via Spells, Crystal Tears and Consumables

Does not include sources that apply a manually triggerable heal such as Godskin Swaddling Cloth, Blood Tax, Prayerful Strike and Greatstars

As part of the priorities for the ruleset, we have many methods of unnecessary stalling such as via regen as this can cause fights to last several times as long as normal. *See Ruleset Priorities.* The reason the exceptions here are not banned are that they require you to attack your opponent, which promotes interactive gameplay rather than stalling.

- Rune Arc (Allowed in Better Multiplayer / DEN-Maps)

If in Better Multiplayer / Den Maps, all players can use rune arcs. If playing on vanilla pc or console, only the world's host can use a rune arc. It offers a better quality duelling experience when all players can use a rune arc, offering unique build-design opportunities and a better hp pool overall but if only one player can use it isn't a fair duel.

- Blue flasks limited to 2

Certain mage strategies are able to consistently loop spells that set up unavoidable damage and can set up completely safe blue flasks. With the 2 flask limit, those strategies become less viable due to the FP cost that they impose, forcing mages to focus on being more precise with their gameplan whilst also not stopping the build from functioning. For example, Founding Rain Of Stars creates a large zone where the opponent is constantly being damaged, adds a lot of visual clutter stopping players from being able to effectively react to every spell being used inside of it, and causes aimpunch due to the poised attacks making players extremely disincentivised from pressuring into it. However, while outside of it, frametrap spells such as Star Shower will keep chipping the opponent as they cannot be completely dodged if you're not at close range or on extremely high latency to double roll it. These two spells can be safely looped for every blue flask the user has. This kind of cheese strategy was dealt with by adding a limit to the amount of blue flasks each player can use because they are very FP intensive, without actually banning any of the spells directly as there are many alternatives. Some may consider mage builds to be underpowered.

- Fan Daggers

Fan Daggers are unavoidable and if used correctly are unpunishable ranged chip damage that adds up a lot throughout the fight. If it were legal both players would use all 40 every single fight because it is that safe and free to use.

- Spectral Steed Whistle

Torrent may be accessible on certain modded versions of the game, in certain duelling arenas but for the sake of ladder and tourneys this is banned as it has nothing to do with duelling. Feel free to host your own jousting tournaments though.

- Spirit Ashes

Spirit ashes may be accessible on certain modded versions of the game, in certain duelling arenas but for the sake of ladder and tourneys this is banned as it has nothing to do with duelling. Feel free to host your own Pokémon tournaments though.

- Blocking with Shields Banned

Shields have been one of the strongest setups in the game due being able to hard counter the majority of the setups in the game especially when using dagshield. Most setups will either get countered by the shield or just lose to the dagger itself, making the only viable setups into dagshield essentially just bottled down to setups like sham/estoc can keep priority into shields with their light attacks whilst also being able to actually compete with the mainhand dagger itself. Even in those few matchups where you can compete with dagshield, the shield is still able to shut down a lot of mix-ups and makes most fights extremely safe and passive due to shield being able to block unreactables and completely shut down backswings very easily, ultimately making dagshield in its worst matchups equal with other top meta setups, and at best able to hardcounter the rest of the game.

[General Rulings]

- Intended Use

For banned content, equipping them will be treated as intended use and result in a round loss. (Equipping a banned AoW but not using it is an exception). This is to draw a hard line on rulebreaks in order to not waste time during tourneys discussing if a rule break was "on purpose" or not. The responsibility is on the players to not accidentally break a rule.

- 3 Ash ruleset

Whilst not a rule currently for ladder, this rule has been used in several tournaments and is important to understand. This ruleset legalises all ashes of wars, but players are only allowed to use an ash of war 3 separate times per fight. Ash of war followups do not add to the count (e.g repeated presses of stormblade/weedcutter/followup of flamestrike still only count as one ash usage.) This ruleset is generally well-balanced, since spamming the ashes of war cannot dominate the fight and there's an opportunity cost to choosing one broken ash over another.

[CRYSTAL TEARS]

- Deflecting Hardtear
This Crystal Tear actively reduces the pool of setups in the meta, as it essentially allows any slow setup in the game to be completely hard countered due to the deflects and guard-counters for high damage and stealing priority against most setups.

- Leaden Hardtear
This Crystal Tear makes the user unable to be stunned for the duration of this Crystal Tear. Whilst this does only last for 10 seconds, it essentially exists to set up cheese strategies and this does not fit in with our vision for competitive duels as being unable to be stunned offers little counterplay to certain strategies.

- Winged Crystal Tear
This Crystal Tear increases the user's maximum equip-load substantially, allowing players to be light rolling with the heaviest setups and it lasts for longer than an average fight would take. Additionally, it is possible to equip several extremely heavy weapons in the unused equipment slots in order to ensure that the user is medium rolling which means that even with light equip-load being banned, this Crystal Tear would allow the user to not invest any points whatsoever into endurance and put the rest of that into damage, massively warping build-making in an unhealthy manner.

- Windy Crystal Tear
This Crystal Tear, along with ALL effects that boost the I-frames on dodge-rolls are banned due to making dodges too safe, especially on higher latencies as this can lead to many mistakes going unpunished - enough so that they outweigh the nerfs to defences.

- Stonebarb Cracked Tear
The ruleset has been designed with possible poise values in mind for balancing. This Crystal Tear causes several setups to become much stronger than intended, hurting the balance of the ruleset. While it only lasts for 30 seconds, due to the selection of Crystal Tears available it has effectively no opportunity cost for using this and so it will inevitably result in stalling becoming extremely incentivised in order to mitigate that Crystal Tears, which is something that we want to avoid.

- All stat Boosting Crystal Tears
The knot crystal tears that increase stats by 10 have been banned as it essentially provided players with the option to play with a level 135 build equivalent and the main setups that benefitted from this were for the most part meta setups. For example, the extra 10 points allowed a setup like Halaxe to reach damage soft caps, whilst still having the endurance to have the best armour, 4 talismans available and a second axe for handy tech. Whilst there were setups that benefitted more from the +10 Tears other than this setup that aren't as commonly seen in the meta, such as caster builds, the community consensus was that build-making was less interesting with it allowed to the point of wanting to ban it.

- All Damage Boosting Crystal Tears
These Crystal Tears have been banned in order to reduce the damage players can deal in order to increase the amount of hits it takes to kill someone. One of our priorities in the ruleset is to maintain a higher TTK and this is one of those bans in order to maintain that agenda.

[EQUIPMENT]

- Light Load (<30% Roll)

Despite being forced onto weaker armour, light roll consistently outperforms medium load due to being able to roll outside of the range of most weapon's attacks making it impossible to rollcatch. Especially in a game like this where mixups setting up rollcatches are so important, light rolling being able to roll outside a player's weapon range consistently undermines the competitive integrity of the ruleset as mistakes are not able to be punished.

- All Pieces of:

Briar Armour

This armour set adds damage on to a player's roll but it has been banned due to the aimpunch bug. This bug results in an attack's hitbox being flicked out of position due to poising an attack, resulting in very janky gameplay due to attacks that were correctly spaced and timed whiffing randomly.

Rakshasa's Armour

Gives users a 2% damage buff per set piece at the cost of worse defenses but is optimally swapped to when at low hp where the defenses do not matter as you'll die in one hit anyway. Banned along with red feather to reduce the damage that a player can put out when at low hp to help maintain the competitive integrity of the ruleset.

[SPELLS]

- Gravitational Missile

This spell has been banned for two reasons: for balance and a bug. Firstly, this is by far, the strongest spell in the game, and would cause mages to overperform in the current meta, with only real counterplay to this spell being the banned Ash of War Endure. Secondly, this spell is extremely prone to desyncing on the opponent's screen. Any spell with similar projectile properties can desync, however, this one is generally the most egregious in its frequency and applications.

- Night Maiden's Mist

This spell has been banned for the sake of the quality of life for players as on some systems this can tank framerate.

[TALISMANS]

- Crucible Feather and Tali. of All Crucibles

This talisman, along with ALL effects that boost the I-frames on dodge-rolls are banned due to making dodges too safe, especially on higher latencies as this can lead to many mistakes going unpunished - enough so that they outweigh the nerfs to defences.

- Fine Crucible Feather Talisman

This talisman boosts I-frames on backsteps too much, allowing for overlapping I-frames on some latencies. Additionally, I-frames on backsteps allows for ravioli backstabs on reaction to slow attacks, reducing meta variety as now players can be completely hard countered for using a slow setup with 1 talisman, funnelling players to use only fast weapons to compete.

- Two-Handed Sword Tali.

This talisman applies 10% damage boost to two handed attacks. This is very unhealthy for the meta as it applies too much of a damage boost to only some of the meta setups. Without it, we have seen a variety of two-handed, paired and offhand-based setups see competitive play but it stops being the case with a 10% damage boost for the arguably strongest group out of those.

- Dagger Talisman

This talisman increases the damage of critical hits by a large amount. This is banned for the sake of maintaining a healthy TTK.

- Spear Talisman on Sword Lance

Due to the already high base damage on Sword Lance and this setup's ability to force trades in neutral, spear talisman applies too much of a damage boost on trades that would push it to overperform in the current meta.

- Red Feather

This talisman applies too much of a damage boost at low hp, allowing players that were losing to very quickly come back and potentially win a match in many less attacks than it took to get them to that point. If we look at it based on the number of interactions, the player that was losing had taken several hits to get to low hp, and then a few more hits in blue feather range in order to be finished off. Whereas, the player that was losing is now in Red Feather range and can kill their opponent in 20% less interactions than if they didn't have access to the damage boost. This also allows them to potentially deal enough damage to skip most, if not all of the opponent's Blue Feather Talisman range, reducing the number of interactions needed to finish off their opponent by another 20%. This much variance in the number of interactions it takes to kill makes a very big divide in the effort needed to win depending on the situation, hurting the competitive integrity of the fights.

[GREASES]

- Rot Greases
Rot Greases provide an extremely high amount of pressure for any interaction due to how high the reward is for inflicting rot on your opponent, allowing players to snowball with their pressure way too easily.

- Sleep greases on Ripple Weapons
These weapons have built-in S in Arcane scaling which causes sleep status buildup to scale from grease usage, allowing players to inflict sleep in a small number of hits/ghost hits leading to a high damage sleep punish. Ultimately there is just too much reward and applying sleep through iframes on ghost hits makes it overperform on most latencies.

- Poison greases on 2h Shamshir
Able to inflict poison very quickly due to its fast moveset, whilst also having a high damage bolus punish in the form of jumping r2 r1 true combo or a similar amount of damage from the opponent letting the poison go unhealed. This is banned because it would overperform with the current ruleset.

- All Greases on 2H Twinblades
The entire Twinblade weapon class has been performing extremely well in competitive environments for a very long time, and a lot of the community have felt that the damage is simply too high without restrictions for the current meta. The reason that we have opted for grease restriction on Twinblades rather than buff restriction like most other meta setups is that Twinblades are very reliant on spinning slash and so playing with self buff ashes of war like sacred blade has a tangible opportunity cost as you'll miss out on spinning slash. This is only the first iteration of finding a healthier balance for Twinblades in the current meta, and is most likely subject to change in future updates.

[BUFF RESTRICTIONS]

Limiting ALL buffs rather than just greases ensures that people do not circumvent grease restrictions by moving to use an ash of war or spell buff. These bans are based on the relative power-level of the meta, and are heavily dependent on community feedback, and results from ladder/tournaments and as such are subject to change as the meta develops.

All Greases, as well as Spells and ash of wars that apply a buff to the weapon banned from being applied to:

- Two handed Thrusting Sword

This weapon class is arguably one of the strongest in the game. Without any buffs, it still performs extremely well in competitive environments in the current Meta's power level, making it a strong contender for top 3 strongest setups in the rules.

- Two handed Stone Club/Club

This setup, whilst having the speed of a small weapon has hyperarmour and damage comparable to great weapons. This doubles as a status restriction for stone club, as it heavily outperforms in the current ruleset's power level with access to status or high damage from buffs. Despite the restrictions it is still an extremely strong meta relevant setup.

- Two handed Sword Lance

Due to the already high base damage on Sword Lance and this setup's ability to force trades in neutral, damage buffs would push it to overperform in the current meta.

- Two handed Raptors Talons

Due to the high damage that this setup can put out, the highest damage infusion has been banned in conjunction with the buff restrict rule in order to keep the setup in check but not outright banned.

- Offhand Dagger

This weapon class is one of the best offhand weapons in the game due to being completely unreactable, able to frametrap with backswings and very low recovery. Losing trades while being poisable is its only downside, and so flat damage buffs can make this deal too much damage.

- Offhand Axe

One of the best offhand weapons in the game. Its base damage is already high and it is borderline unreactable whilst being able to poisebreak and frametrap on backswing. Buffing this makes it overperform in the current ruleset as it is already used on some of the strongest setups in the meta and performs extremely well without buffs.

- Mainhand One handed Wakizashi

One of the best One-Handed weapons in the game and able to be used in a variety of setups such as on a hybrid caster build, Dagger+Shield, Waki-Axe, etc and would definitely overperform in the current ruleset's powerlevel with access to damage buffs because it has access to unreactable light attacks, and hard priority on the first two heavy attacks.

- Two-Handed Greatspears

This setup has access to extremely long ranged unreactable attacks and hyperarmour to set up high damage vortexes. Despite the damage restriction, it is still performing extremely well in the current meta.

- Two-Handed Star Fists

Fists have been a strong meta contender due to their high damage and unreactable attacks. By restricting Star Fists from buffs we push people down to a slight downgrade in the form of Iron Balls.

[WEAPONS]

The following bans exist to improve the pool of viable setups that can be used in a competitive environment. There is room for rulesets with higher power-levels with the following setups banned, or even lower power levels with even more bans. This iteration is simply what the consensus of the duelling community has decided as the most enjoyable and skill expressive for a competitive environment.

- 2H Duelling Shield

Two Handed Thrusting Shield weapon class has proven to be among the strongest setups in the game. This moveset has hyper armour during startup, block frames during the recovery, two-handed guardboost bonus, pierce damage for counterhit trades, and the option to shieldpoke. This has made this weapon class massively outperform almost every setup in the game.

- Carian Thrusting Shield

This weapon was banned in all hands in order to keep one handed/offhand thrusting shields in check as now they can only use the inferior weapon in this class - that being duelling shield when used in one hand. This is the superior version specifically due to higher guardboost available.

- 2H/PS Backhand Blade (Class)

Two handed/Paired bhb moveset has access to very high damage, unreactables and frame traps. Proven to be very dominant in competitive environments. The one-handed moveset has not overperformed and so it stays unbanned.

- Smithscript Cirque

Due to the projectiles, this weapon specifically is banned despite one handed backhand blades being legal as their projectiles are extremely potent at zoning and makes the one-handed backhand blades moveset overperform in the current meta.

- 2h Cleanrot Knight's Sword

Thrusting Swords have proven to consistently be one of the strongest weapon classes in the game. Banning cleanrot (the longest thrusting sword) along with the damage buff restrictions are what has kept this weapon class in check without having to ban it completely. Cleanrot Knight's Sword is still legal to be used in one handed, paired and in offhand.

- Pata

This weapon has proven to overperform based on the current ruleset's power level due to its unique true combos, and the pierce fists moveset giving it counterhit damage trades. But by far its strongest quality is its absurd range compared to the rest of the weapon class.

- Claws of Night

This weapon has unique projectiles on the heavies that are able to constantly be thrown out, high damage due to its extremely high AR compared to the rest of class, and extremely long hitbox for its moveset allowing for easy backswings which makes this weapon one of the strongest in the game.

- Smithscript Shield

This weapon is essentially just low recovery low FP cost projectile spam that is really easy to spam and hard to avoid lending itself to very noninteractive gameplay loops of one player stalling out the

opponent's FP bar or face tanking damage to actually break neutral - which notably most setups won’t be able to confirm any damage in that situation.

- Spread Crossbow

Spread Crossbow is one of the strongest utility tools in the game. It has very high damage at close range, its projectile release is completely unreactable at most ranges, and is able to apply status very quickly. Reloading is also relatively safe, and generally the damage and ranged harassment it provides is able to make up for any pressure undertaken in order to reload.

- Offhand Rakshasa's Great Katana

This weapon has access to a massive amount of hyper armour, enough hitstun to true combo into fast mainhand weapons' attacks and is very easy to pair with some of the best mainhand setups. It has consistently performed well in competitive environments. Despite not being particularly broken, especially in comparison to some of the other weapons on the banlist as its counterplay is very tame, offrak simply performs too well in the current ruleset compared to the rest of the metapool and as such its presence would severely impact the variety available of meta setups that can compete.

- Lightning infused Raptor's Talons

Due to the high damage that this setup can put out, the highest damage infusion has been banned in conjunction with the buff restrict rule in order to keep the setup in check but not outright banned. This infusion notably has much higher damage on this setup than the other infusions, making it a noticeable nerf.

- Access to status in 2h Stone Club/Club

Due to the stone club moveset's speed and hyperarmour, counterplay against it requires patiently dodging attacks until you're in a safe position to punish its whiffs - which is hard to time due to only having 8 frames of recovery where not in hyper armour when mashing r1, or 1 frame without hyper armour if trying to roll. Any access to status (which can be applied through ghost hits) shuts down its only lose condition as it now puts the opponent onto a timer from the status. This rule is in place in order to keep the setup in check but not outright banned.

- Smithscript Dagger

This weapon's jump attacks can consistently headshot (which can happen during I-frames) and then loop that headshot a second time as a true combo. Even when used just in the offhand (while still abusing meta mainhand weapons), the projectiles are extremely fast and hard to strafe while trying to actually close the gap with the opponent, making them very safe and infinitely spammable zoning tool that forces the opponent to be extremely passive and cautious. This has consistently overperformed in a competitive environment simply due to how consistently cautious you need to play in order to fight against it without taking unnecessary damage.

- Milady

Due to the high damage, range, uniquely high poise damage even on ashes of war, and most importantly the frametraps that this weapon can set up, Milady has consistently overperformed in competitive environments. Other weapons in the Light Greatsword weapon class are still legal so that players can still use the moveset, but more toned down due to having no access to infusions, ash of wars, buffs and can't be used on a strength build in order to keep the setup in check but not outright banned.

[ASHES OF WAR]

All of these ashes of wars are banned for the sake of maintaining an interesting gameplay loop, as they are across the board extremely spammable and low risk compared to the reward that it provides, warping the entire meta around it. A good way to look at how it warps the meta is that if any of these are used in a duel, they affect almost every single interaction in that duel and are likely safely spammed repeatedly throughout the fight.

- Bloodhound's Step

Bloodhound Step (commonly known as BHS) has access to Frame 1 I-frames "on press" which, despite having less I-frames than a roll, makes it able to be used as a dodge tool more effectively than even the roll button because rolling is "on release" which adds some delay. Additionally, Bloodhound's Step is classified as a "fast ash of war" (giving attacks an earlier recovery cancel window into it) making it extremely effective in duels for escaping true combos and in general recovery cancelling attacks into I-frames faster than a dodge would allowing for most setups to get even more priority and safety when whiffing than dodge rolling. Furthermore, due to the range that BHS has, allows it to cause attacks to fail to track it where they would normally track just fine against a normal roll. Ultimately it would dominate the ruleset if it were legal.

- Quickstep

Quickstep has access to Frame 1 I-frames "on press" which, despite having less I-frames than a roll, makes it able to be used as a dodge tool more effectively than even the roll button because rolling is "on release" which adds some delay. Additionally, Quickstep is classified as a "fast ash of war" (giving attacks an earlier recovery cancel window into it) making it extremely effective in duels for escaping true combos and in general recovery cancelling attacks into I-frames faster than a dodge would allowing for most setups to get even more priority and safety when whiffing than dodge rolling. Ultimately it would dominate the ruleset if it were legal.

- Raptor of the Mists

This ash of war is banned for all the same reasons as BHS. Whilst raptor of the mist functions differently from BHS as it puts the user into the air afterwards for a jumping attack. Additionally, it is uniquely possible to cancel raptors into a crouch and then into another raptors, which is an easy method for overlapping I-frames on higher latencies.

- Flaming Strike

This ash of war is one of the strongest ashes of war in Elden Ring and is banned due to how much it dominates every aspect of a duel. Due to its lingering hitbox, in neutral it is practically unpunishable by most melee attacks and on trade (due to level 2 hit stun) it always sets up trade combos into attacks with less stun than it making the flame spray extremely safe and high reward to throw out in neutral or to keep priority against mash attempts and it's low cost means you can spam this dozens of times a duel safely. Additionally, its lingering hitbox and high damage also makes it one of the easiest to land roll catches as it is able to frametrap except on high latencies and any late hit of the ash due to the roll catch timing will set up a true combo into the ash's follow-up for very high damage.

- All Parries

All parries have proven to be extremely potent in a competitive environment due to the extremely high reward it poses compared to its extremely low risk. Elden Ring parries are uniquely powerful compared to previous titles due to its extremely low recovery making the most you can get to punish a whiffed parry being just frame advantage. The perceived difficulty of parries also does not affect this,

as many setup parries simply need you to make a read on a situation where you would force a trade and you will get rewarded with close to a 1-shot. They especially have been made even more effective in competitive environments, because of all of the increases to TTK which all just give more opportunities for a player to lose all their health in a single interaction.

- Endure
Endure is a highly spammable, low risk ash of war. Due to the defence and poise increase during the endure window, it essentially negates all pressure and forces the opponent to back off until it ends to not take massively losing trades. Essentially this ash of war shuts down a lot of the avenues for skill expression in duels.

- Oath of Vengeance
Same issues as endure, except it lasts longer and raises all stats by 5 for 60 seconds. This one also lasts long enough to set up certain cheese strategies as it lasts long enough to set up any action safely.

- Royal Knights Resolve
This ash of war applies a 40% damage buff for next hit. Due to the low recovery, it is very easy to reapply and so it simply acts as too much of a damage buff with no downside, reducing TTK.

- Determination
This ash of war applies a 30% damage buff for next hit. Due to the low recovery, it is very easy to reapply and so it simply acts as too much of a damage buff with no downside, reducing TTK.

- Storm Stomp
This ash has fast hyperarmour that can be used to easily take a winning trade with whiff punish attempts, a lingering hitbox that makes it very unviable to punish when whiffed and doubles as a good rollcatch tool. The low FP cost makes this very easy to spam constantly throughout the fight.

- Storm Assault, Stormcaller & Red Bear Hunt
These ashes of war have very fast hyper armour startup, high damage for taking hugely winning trades and in general are very hard to punish due to their lingering hitboxes.

- Swift Slash
This ash of war is banned because it is always able to guarantee damage with frametraps if the opponent isn't in a position to interrupt its startup, and extremely high damage when the full ash lands. This ash would vastly overperform compared to the rest of the meta and as such was banned from competitive play

- Blind Spot
This ash of war is a very safe attack with I-frames that can be used to cancel recoveries similarly to bhs/qs allowing you to take completely safe trades against whiff punish attempts. Furthermore, due to the range of the blindspot attack, whiff punishing it is unrealistic.

Needle Piercer
This ash is able to remove all buffs on target even on ghost hits. Due to the ruleset's reliance on crystal tears to manage the TTK, this ash of war warps the gameplay too much.

- Fast Sword Dance

This ash of war has been banned on any setup where it uses the fast sword dance animation (For reference, Shamshir uses fast sword dance.) This Ash of war has fast hyper armour startup, good damage and is hard to roll consistently, making it able to be used to cover whiffs with a winning hyperarmour trade easily and just in general being a very safe attack to spam throughout the fight.

- Barbaric Roar

This ash of war changes the heavy attack chain of the setup using it to a high damage, fast attack with enough hyperarmour to poise through colossal weapon attacks. This is most effective on setups like Star Fists because while it's possible to poise the middle hit of the Barbaric Roar R2 attack chain, you will actively be punished for using that much poise against it as it then allows for poise chip looping. Ultimately proved to be too powerful for the current ruleset's powerlevel.

- Shriek of Sorrow

This ash is a buff that gains more damage the lower hp that you're on, until you're at 20% damage boost at low hp, effectively acting as a second red feather. Results in too much of a damage boost to maintain a healthy TTK.

- Painful Strikes

This is the ash of war on Tooth Whip. Once you set up the poise chip, it becomes a dagger speed, high damage ash that true combos into your offhand and with offhand axe it can loop the poise chip via backswing. It is banned because it overperforms in the current power level of the ruleset.

- Chilling Mist applied on cold infused weapons

This ash of war works on any build for any setup to set up a 3 hit cold procc that applies a 20% defence debuff to the opponent whilst you swap to a higher damage infusion making it very easy to apply and punish any bolus attempts multiple times a fight. Counterplay boils down to either stalling out the status/buff or just mirroring so that both players are equally debuffed.

[Blacklisted Glitches/Techs]

Many of the banned glitches are self explanatory, but some players may not be aware of what exactly some of the lesser known glitches are, and so informing of this would help players to avoid accidentally using them.

- Armor swap poise reset

It is possible to reset your poise health back to 100% without using an attack by removing armour until your poise is less than the amount you were chipped for and then re-equipping your armour. This removes a lot of setup variety by essentially killing setups that rely on poise counting via an unpunishable poise reset.

- Block Desync

One of the main methods of setting up a desync is the block desync which makes attacks completely unanimated. Banned for the obvious reason of players attacking each other with consistently replicate-able attacks that have no animation.

- Offhand drawstring poison grease

Using poison grease on a weapon that you're two-handing from within your offhand will cause much higher poison build-up on multi-hitting attacks, so poison grease is banned on offhand weapons in general to avoid this bug.

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